Classroom Coaching Policy

Performance Standard

§ 1302.92(c) Training and professional development.

(c) A program must implement a research-based, coordinated coaching strategy for education staff that:

(1) Assesses all education staff to identify strengths, areas of needed support, and which staff would benefit most from intensive coaching;

(2) At a minimum, provides opportunities for intensive coaching to those education staff identified through the process in paragraph (c)(1) of this section, including opportunities to be observed and receive feedback and modeling of effective teacher practices directly related to program performance goals;

(3) At a minimum, provides opportunities for education staff not identified for intensive coaching through the process in paragraph (c)(1) of this section to receive other forms of research-based professional development aligned with program performance goals;

(4) Ensures intensive coaching opportunities for the staff identified through the process in paragraph (c)(1) of this section that:

(i) Align with the program's school readiness goals, curricula, and other approaches to professional development;

(ii) Utilize a coach with adequate training and experience in adult learning and in using assessment data to drive coaching strategies aligned with program performance goals;

(iii) Provide ongoing communication between the coach, program director, education director, and any other relevant staff; and,

(iv) Include clearly articulated goals informed by the program's goals, as described in §1302.102, and a process for achieving those goals; and,

(5) Establishes policies that ensure assessment results are not used to solely determine punitive actions for staff identified as needing support, without providing time and resources for staff to improve.

Policy

In accordance with HSPPS 1302.92, PPS Early Learners PreK implements a coordinated coaching plan for all education staff that assesses their strengths and needs and supports them in developing their skills and knowledge in order to provide high quality, comprehensive services to children and families. Coaching is related to staff needs, professional development goals, as well as the agency's School Readiness Goals and their alignment with the *Head Start Early Learning Outcomes Framework: Ages Birth to Five* and adopted, research-based curriculums. Coaching is used to support effective teaching practices and to increase positive child outcomes. Coaching includes focused observations, reflections, feedback, and planning goals and action steps to support teachers' professional development. The goal of coaching is to provide a systematic way for all teachers to reflect upon their practices and to make continuous improvement in their professional development. It provides an opportunity for teachers, teacher assistants, and other Early Learners education staff to try new approaches and/or practices in the classroom. Coaching supplements supervision and works in coordination with professional development and is related to professional development plans. PPS Early Learners will utilize the Practiced-Based Coaching model to help support high-quality teaching and learning practices. Availability of specific coaching models will be an annual decision based on available financial and staffing resources.

Procedure

Coaching sessions are a place for teachers to reflect and explore their own practices. If something new is tried and doesn't go well, the Instructional Coach and teacher discuss, reflect, and refine. Coaching plans should always work in conjunction with program plans. The supervisor and the coach should communicate regularly to help coordinate this process.

If a serious issue or risk is observed, the coach is responsible to ensure immediate correction with the teacher and to notify their supervisor.

The following tools and observations may be used to guide and inform coaching: Teaching Pyramid Observation Tool (TPOT), Tools of the Mind (TOTM), Heggerty, DRDP data, lesson plan and records reviews along with other observational tools available to Education Supervisors.

Instructional Coaches will:

- Support teachers to assess his/her strengths and needs with effective instructional practices.
- Develop an individualized coaching plan with identified teachers that includes goals related to improving school readiness outcomes for all children. The plan will include steps for achieving goals and the coach's and teacher's responsibilities related to each step. The individualized coaching plan will be based on observations and data points for each classroom.
- Schedule, plan, and facilitate onsite visits and coaching sessions.
- Provide support in the form of sharing resources, providing models of effective practices, observing the teacher's current practices, and providing supportive and constructive feedback.
- Remain supportive and maintain—to the maximum extent possible—a separation between coaching and performance evaluation. However, relevant progress, growth, and concerns should be communicated between the coach and supervisor as appropriate.
- Document coaching sessions on a tracking spreadsheet.
- Develop, with input from the supervisor and staff person, a Coaching Agreement for each teacher and a formal monthly Action Plan with each identified teacher.

Teachers will:

- Actively engage in the coaching process by assessing one's strengths and needs, asking questions, sharing relevant information, reflecting, listening, and identifying goals and means to achieve those goals in collaboration with the coach and/or supervisor.
- Use data to inform decision making and planning.
- Be open to being observed and receiving feedback.
- Apply and analyze teaching practices with the support of an assigned coach according to determined criteria.

Coaching Model Determination Criteria

Classroom teachers will be assigned to one or more of the following coaching models:

- Self-Coaching (PPS Student Growth & Professional Development Goals Process)
- Expert Coaching (when documented coaching needs are identified, may be site based, i.e. Pilot school, will use PBC model)
- Teachers new to Early Learners PreK for the first three years in the program.
- Teaching & Learning Collaborative Model (when financial and staffing resource support program-wide implementation)

Coaching model options may include:

- All teachers will participate in the development, review, and revision of PPS Student Growth and Professional Development Goals. Teachers will:
  - Analyze student data to develop two relevant SMART goals that address all of their students.
  - Access intentional resources and tools.
  - Participate in Fall, Mid-Year and End of Year check-ins with the Early Learners Administrator.
  - Access the Early Learners Administrator for content-specific expert guidance and tools as needed.
  - Utilize Feedback Conferences with Early Learners Administrator, Instructional Coaches, mentors.
- Staff who have demonstrated a need for intentional and specific skill development according to any essential job duties according to their job description, documented by observations (TOTM, regularly scheduled observations) and/or performance evaluation will be assigned to the Expert Coaching model. Staff participating in this model will participate in:
  - Frequent coaching and reflection.

- Development of an Individualized Action Plan that may include:
  - Reflection
  - Data Analysis
  - Observation of peers and/or self (video reflection)
  - Review of relevant policies and/or tools
  - Regular, scheduled check-ins with coach and/or supervisor

In all instances, staff will also have access to internal and external Professional Development opportunities that are deemed appropriate by the Supervisor and/or Early Learners Administrator. These opportunities should align with the individual's professional development goals and their individualized coaching plan.

Specific guidelines for coaching based on relevant observations are as follows, and will be determined at the beginning of the program year annually by the Director of Early Learners and Early Learners Administrator.

Staffing and fiscal resources will impact the coaching model(s) available each year:

	TOTM (Tools of the Mind Curriculum Focus)	**PBIS- Pyramid Model** (Social Emotional Focus)
PBC-Expert Coaching*	Below Expectations as documented in TOTM Look For Observations	Based on recommendations from the Education Supervisor and Mental Health Consultant

*The frequency of Expert Coaching sessions may be adjusted with documented need.